

Japan Technology: Hardware – Electronic Components: June MOF trade statistics (MLCC): ASP/volume up mom suggests further tightening

According to Ministry of Finance (MOF) trade statistics for June, announced on July 30, the average export price for MLCCs was up +4% mom, while export volume was up +6%, and export value was up +11%. On a yoy basis, these figures were +23%/+6%/+31%. **According to our industry supply chain checks, there is a possibility that supply/demand tightness strengthened further in June**, and we believe these figures align with this view. **Amid an ongoing strong demand outlook for AI/DC applications, supply concerns are growing for other applications as well, and we believe customers generally may be rushing to procure for 2026 and increasing their requests for 2027 LTAs.**

We maintain our Buy ratings on Murata Mfg. (on CL), Taiyo Yuden, and TDK. Murata Mfg., TDK, and Taiyo Yuden are scheduled to announce 1Q results on July 31 (14:00), July 31 (15:30), and August 5 (15:30), respectively. **Although share prices of MLCC stocks are currently in a correction phase, we believe fundamentals have actually strengthened further over the past month.** At the upcoming results, **we will be focusing on (1) BB ratio** (potential for further qoq increase in Apr-Jun), **(2) pricing strategy** (whether there are any new moves or signs from Japanese manufacturers, which have kept prices flat, amid increasing activity by Asian companies), and **(3) capacity utilization and supply capabilities.**

Daiki Takayama

+81(3)4587-9870 |
daiki.takayama@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Mitsuhiro Icho

+81(3)4587-9836 |
mitsuhiro.x.icho@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

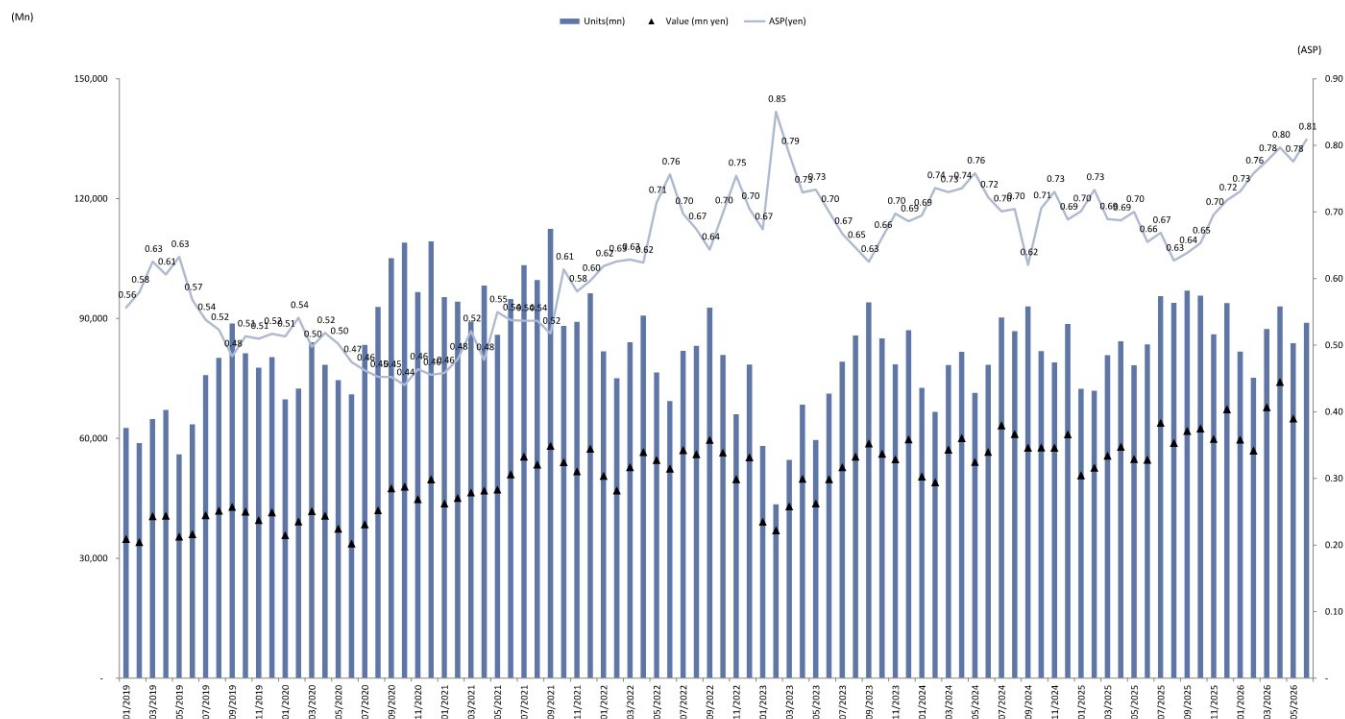
Makoto Takahara

+81(3)4587-4270 |
makoto.takahara@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Yuji Hidaka

+81(3)4587-3656 | yuji.hidaka@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

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Exhibit 1: MLCC export volume and average export price (ASP)

Source: Ministry of Finance

Price target risks and methodology**Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.**

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Taiyo Yuden

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Taiyo Yuden with a 12-month price target of ¥21,200. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/29E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of

¥4,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Contributing Authors: Daiki Takayama Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Mitsuhiro Ichio Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Makoto Takahara Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Yuji Hidaka Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd..

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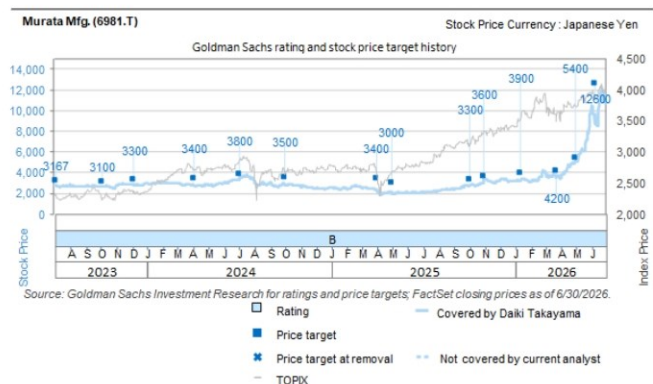
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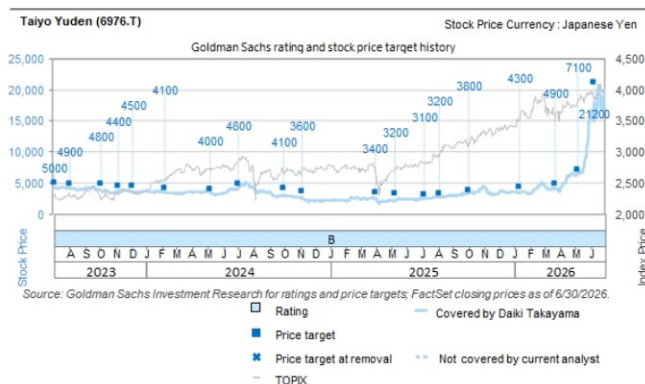
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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
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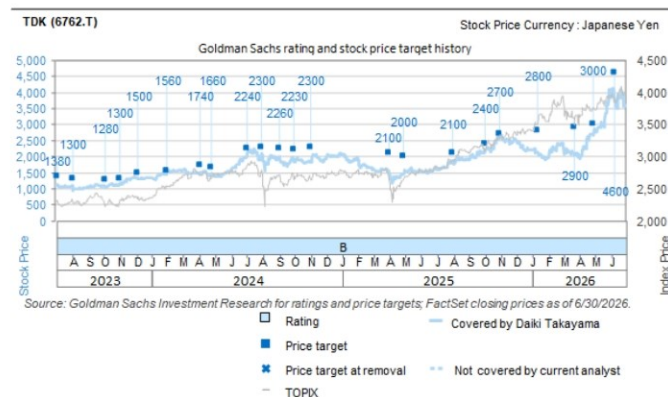
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Target price history table(s)

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	21,200	14,975
08-May-26	7,100	6,663
23-Mar-26	4,900	3,926
12-Jan-26	4,300	3,405
02-Oct-25	3,800	3,382
05-Aug-25	3,200	2,841
07-Jul-25	3,100	2,488
09-May-25	3,200	2,202
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,467
07-Nov-24	3,600	2,781
01-Oct-24	4,100	3,081
02-Jul-24	4,800	4,105
08-May-24	4,000	3,643

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
07-Feb-24	4,100	3,431
06-Dec-23	4,500	3,627
07-Nov-23	4,400	3,695
04-Oct-23	4,800	3,963
03-Aug-23	4,900	4,164

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
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TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052
02-Aug-23	6,500	1,089

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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